

ARY ZULFIKAR

Advancing Indonesian MSMEs in the Digital Era

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Born in 1971, Ary Zulfikar, known as Azoo, is a man of many talents who wanted to be a journalist like his father. Remarkably Azoo's parents told him, "Whatever the work, it must be done in earnest, not just making money but how we manage the work and carry it out." "My mother taught me that there is nothing impossible, so everything, if you really do it can be done well. This is what motivates me to stay ahead and work as well as possible," said Azoo. His deep respect for his parents' words has done him very well in meeting the challenges he faced daily in life as a lawyer and a businessman. Numerous awards were to follow for his ability to hold to this principle and garnered very deep and heartfelt respect from his peers and work colleagues.

After high school, Azoo completed his education at the Faculty of Law at Padjajaran University and graduated in 1994 and started his career as a lawyer through the law firm Kartini Muljadi &Rekan (KMR). Through many hurdles, Azoo finally established his own law firm under the name AZP Legal Consultants after gaining much experience at his old law firm. AZP Legal Consultans has received many awards, including being listed as the Top 30 Largest Law Consultants and ranked 10th in the Legal League Table of Bloomberg in 2011 as legal advisors for bond issuance. They received awards in assisting the Government of the Republic of Indonesia in the issuance of Government bonds, namely the Indonesia Deal of the Year – Government of Indonesia's US\$ 1.25 billion Green Sovereign Sukuk by IFN Awards 2018. A Sovereign Deal of the Year – Government of Indonesia's US\$ 1.25 billion Green Sovereign Sukuk by IFN Awards 2018 and the Islamic Finance News Deals of The Year, Sukuk Retail Publishing, Ministry of the Republic of Indonesia, 2010 were also included as achievements of his law firm.

In the field of law, Azoo was also recorded to have won many awards for his dedication, including being included in the Top 100 Indonesia Lawyers by the Asia Business Law Journal for four consecutive years, from 2018 to 2021 and awards such as Leading Lawyer in 2014, 2015, 2016, and 2018 in the field of banking and finance from Asialaw. All these were important achievements for Azoo who took it humbly, remembering his parents' advice.

As Legal Executive Director of LPS (Deposit Insurance Corporation) he has met and will overcome many challenges due to his impressive track record. Azoo still took time to bond with friends of Padjajaran University alumni and during the Covid 19 period. It was his idea to form a community of alumni of Padjajaran University. "In 2020, I interacted with friends from campus, I saw that many alumni from Padjajaran did business activities, but not as a life calling but were forced to it because of living conditions and survival," said Azoo.



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Finally, in March 2020, an MSME community was formed by the alumni of PadjadJaran University which was spread across several regions in Indonesia, as a forum for friendship between alumni. This was chaired by Azoo under the name Perkumpulan Bumi Alumni (PBA) with a total participation of more than 800 in Whatsapp groups and other social media platforms, such as Instagram (ig @umkmalumni) with 3,674 followers and Facebook with more than 2,600 followers to date.

The PBA chaired by Azoo became an aggregator in providing guidance and training to its members to work together in order to galvanize the people's economic ecosystem so that it would be even bigger. This began to be developed through digital platforms with the trademark "LUPBA" & "CUPBA" which is a collective mark to accommodate the products of MSME actors. "By developing a digital platform, a community-based market place where MSMEs are sold, where they can become sellers, buyers or as dropshippers, we combine this in a platform called Bumi Alumni Gallery ([www. bumialumni.com](http://www.bumialumni.com)). This melds together with the marketing community, so that those who become members can take advantage of the marketing we do by aiming to bring their products closer to the market", said Azoo in his interview with Registry.

In between his busy schedule, Azoo also has a culinary business. With a friend he opened a Japanese restaurant called "FUKURO DINING & SAKE BAR" located at SCBD Sudirman-South Jakarta. With a luxurious menu presentation and a place that seems cozy, FUKURO Dining & Sake Bar is one of the comfortable choices of places to enjoy lunch, dinner or as a hangout place on weekends with luxurious and classy drinks.

The interview closed with Azoo's message for the younger generation similar to the encouraging slogan, "You definitely can", a phrase that inspired Azoo to succeed to this day, because nothing is impossible in this world, as long as one plans things in earnest. Like his father's message to Azoo, "Dream is part of the goal. Goal is part of the plan. Plan is part of the hard work. And hard work is part of the success. Great people are not produced through ease, pleasure and comfort, they are formed through hardships and challenges."



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